Leyland Australia Morris Major / Austin Freeway & Wolseley 24/80 (Australia) Specificatio

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Leyland Australia | Model: Morris Major / Austin Freeway & Wolseley 24/80 | Australian Market Years
Vehicle Type: 4-door Sedan / 5-door Station Wagon | Segment: Compact / Mid-size | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Victoria Park (Zetland), Sydney, New South Wales

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Morris Major and Austin Freeway family was BMC Australia's dedicated endeavor to engineer v
ehicles specifically for Australian motoring conditions at the Victoria Park plant in Zetland,
Sydney. Commencing in 1958 as the Morris Major (and sibling Austin Lancer), it adapted the Wols
eley 1500 body with increased ground clearance, reinforced suspension, and BMC's 1.5L B-Series
four. In 1962, BMC Australia achieved an extraordinary domestic engineering feat: by extending
the nose structure and casting two extra cylinders onto the 1622cc B-Series block, they created
Australia's first locally designed mass-market inline-six: the 2433cc 'Blue Streak' six. Fitte
d to the Austin Freeway and the luxury Wolseley 24/80 (featuring genuine burr walnut dashboard
and leather seats), the 6-cylinder Freeway competed directly with the Holden and Falcon, offeri
ng 59 kW, outback suspension, and optional Borg-Warner 35 automatic transmission.

The 2.4-litre 'Blue Streak' engine was cast and machined entirely in Australia at BMC's Zetland
engine facility. It used common pistons, conrods, and valvegear with the 4-cylinder B-series,
achieving brilliant manufacturing economies. The Austin Freeway Station Wagon offered immense l
oad space and was standard equipment for many Australian municipal councils and outback traveli
ng salesmen.

SERIES / GENERATION: Major-Series-I-II-Elite (Morris Major (Series I, II & Elite)) [1958-1964]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan | ANCAP: None
Australian-developed 4-cylinder compact sedan. Higher ride clearance, heavy-duty suspension, 1.
5L B-Series engine, followed by 1.6L Elite with finned rear wings.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- BMC-B-Series-1500: 1.5L (1489cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 37.0 kW / 102.0 Nm
- BMC-B-Series-1622: 1.6L (1622cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 45.0 kW / 122.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Morris Major Elite: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, AUD $1780-$1890, Fuel=8.5L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Morris Major Elite | Sedan | BMC-B-Series-1622 | 4-speed manual floor | RWD | 45.0kW/122.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: Freeway-Wolseley-24-80 (Austin Freeway & Wolseley 24/80 (6-Cylinder)) [1962-1965]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon | ANCAP: None
First Australian-designed mass-production inline-six: the 2.4L 'Blue Streak' six. Austin Freewa
y sedan and wagon, and prestige Wolseley 24/80 with burr walnut dash.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Blue-Streak-2433-I6: 2.4L (2433cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 59.0 kW / 167.0 Nm
- Blue-Streak-2433-TwinSU: 2.4L (2433cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 63.0 kW / 174.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Austin Freeway Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column with synchromesh on all gears, Borg
- Wolseley 24/80 Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed manual column, Borg-Warner 35 3-speed automatic,

Factory Configurations:

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* Austin Freeway Sedan | Sedan | Blue-Streak-2433-I6 | 3-speed manual column with synchromesh on all ge
* Wolseley 24/80 Sedan | Sedan | Blue-Streak-2433-TwinSU | Borg-Warner 35 3-speed automatic | RWD | 63.